Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥9

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥4

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠5

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 6 2
♥ A 10 9
♦ A K 3
♣ A K 8 4

♠ Q J 8 5
♥ 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 6 5
♣ 5 2



♠ 10 9 4 3
♥ Q J 4
♦ 10
♣ Q J 10 9 3

♠ A 7
♥ K 3
♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2
♣ 7 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings

7NT by North
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH isn't sure just how much he can make, but surely 6♦ isn't too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and NORTH shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and NORTH shows three.

Hmm, SOUTH can now count all thirteen tricks, so he forgets about the ♦ slam and bids 7NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 7 4 2 ♥ A 10 8 5 3 ♦ J 10 ♣ 3 2	
♠ J 8 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ 8 5 ♣ A K Q 10 9 6	N W E S	♠ A K Q ♥ K Q 6 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ J 8 7 5
	♠ 10 6 5 3 ♥ 9 4 ♦ A 9 7 6 4 2 ♣ 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT			
All Pass			

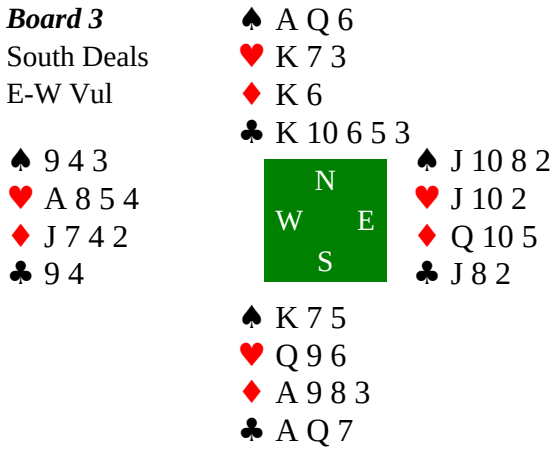
4NT by East
Lead: ♥9

WEST has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			

4NT by South
Lead: ♥4

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 5 3 ♥ A 4 3 2 ♦ Q 10 9 2 ♣ 9 3	
♠ A 8 7 6 ♥ Q J 7 ♦ A J 3 ♣ A 8 2		♠ K Q J 4 ♥ K 6 ♦ K 4 ♣ K Q J 10 5
	♠ 9 2 ♥ 10 9 8 5 ♦ 8 7 6 5 ♣ 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♠5

When WEST opens 1NT EAST hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.